

Ruth Sirma

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SUMMARY

Graduate-level economist with strong training in econometrics and quantitative analysis, experienced in data cleaning, statistical modeling, and visualization using R and Excel. Proven ability to analyze large datasets, build regression and forecasting models, and translate results into actionable insights to support data-driven decision-making.

EXPERIENCE

Dragas Center for Economic Analysis and Policy

Jul. 2024 – Aug. 2024

Graduate Research Assistant

Norfolk, VA

- Cleaned, merged, and analyzed large datasets using R to support applied economic research projects.
- Performed regression and time-series analysis to evaluate economic trends and relationships.
- Developed data visualizations in R to communicate key insights to faculty and policy staff.
- Translated quantitative results into written summaries and presentation materials for decision-makers.
- Ensured data quality through validation, error checking, and documentation.

Old Dominion University, Department of Economics

Aug. 2023 – May 2025

Teaching Assistant

Norfolk, VA

- Graded and analyzed student performance data to monitor academic trends and outcomes.
- Maintained accurate academic records and supported course data management.
- Assisted in developing structured datasets for assignments and assessments.
- Provided timely feedback and supported course administration.

Old Dominion University, Department of Economics

Aug. 2024 – May 2025

MA Program Graduate Student Ambassador

Norfolk, VA

- Represented the university's graduate programs to prospective students and external stakeholders.
- Prepared summary reports on recruitment activities and engagement metrics.
- Maintained organized records and ensured data accuracy across communication channels.
- Supported event logistics and coordinated data collection for program evaluation.

Ministry of Health, Malaria Program

Dec. 2021 – Jun. 2022

Data Entry Clerk

Kenya

- Entered, cleaned, and validated large volumes of health program data with high accuracy.
- Reviewed datasets for inconsistencies and implemented corrections to ensure data integrity.
- Assisted in preparing monitoring and evaluation reports using structured datasets.
- Met strict deadlines while maintaining data quality standards.

EDUCATION

Old Dominion University

May 2025

Master of Arts in Economics (Econometrics & Quantitative Economics)

Norfolk, VA

- GPA: 3.55

Multimedia University of Kenya

Dec 2021

Bachelor of Science in Economics

Kenya

- Second Class Upper

SKILLS

Tools: R, Microsoft Excel (Pivot Tables, Data Cleaning)

Methods: Econometrics, Regression Analysis, Time Series Analysis, Statistical Modeling, Data Cleaning, Data Visualization, Data Interpretation, Presentation of Results

HONORS & AWARDS

Vice President, Global Student Friendship Organization

- Helped international students adjust to campus life by organizing advice sessions on finance, safety, and cultural adaptation.

Outreach Leader, Global Student Friendship Organization